

Relay — Functional Use Cases

Test evidence for beta readiness. Every screenshot below was captured from **production** (relaystandby.com) during the walkthrough, not from a local build or a mock.

Build	master @ c8570d8
Suite	1382 passed / 1 skipped across 139 files · typecheck, lint and build clean
Environment	Production — Vercel, Aurora DSQL (us-east-1 / us-west-2), AWS KMS
Method	A purpose-built owner with a realistic circle: one verified recipient with a passkey, one paper-only recipient, one verified verifier holding an emergency code, one contact who has not accepted yet, two critical vault items, an armed emergency trigger, and one closed incident in the audit chain.
Data handling	All fixtures were deleted afterwards; production returned to its baseline accounts with zero orphaned rows.

Coverage summary

REF	USE CASE	ACTOR	RESULT
UC-01	Know whether the vault could actually open	Owner	Pass
UC-02	Build the circle: invite, verify identity, record a paper-only contact, issue an emergency code	Owner	Pass
UC-03	Decide who can reach what, and under which trigger	Owner	Pass
UC-04	Configure a threshold, initiate a release, stand it down	Owner	Pass
UC-05	Read what happened while they were away	Owner	Pass
UC-06	Export everything, or close the account	Owner	Pass
UC-07	See what they are on standby for, add a passkey, step down	Standby contact	Pass
UC-08	Accept a place using a code given by the owner	Named contact	Pass
UC-09	Get back in with an emergency code after losing a device	Standby contact	Pass
UC-10	Answer "is this real?" without an account	Verifier	Pass
UC-11	Open what was set aside, once a release is confirmed	Recipient	Pass
UC-12	Understand the product before signing up	Visitor	Pass
UC-13	Read what is promised, including as a standby	Visitor	Pass
UC-14	Read what is stored and what is not	Visitor	Pass

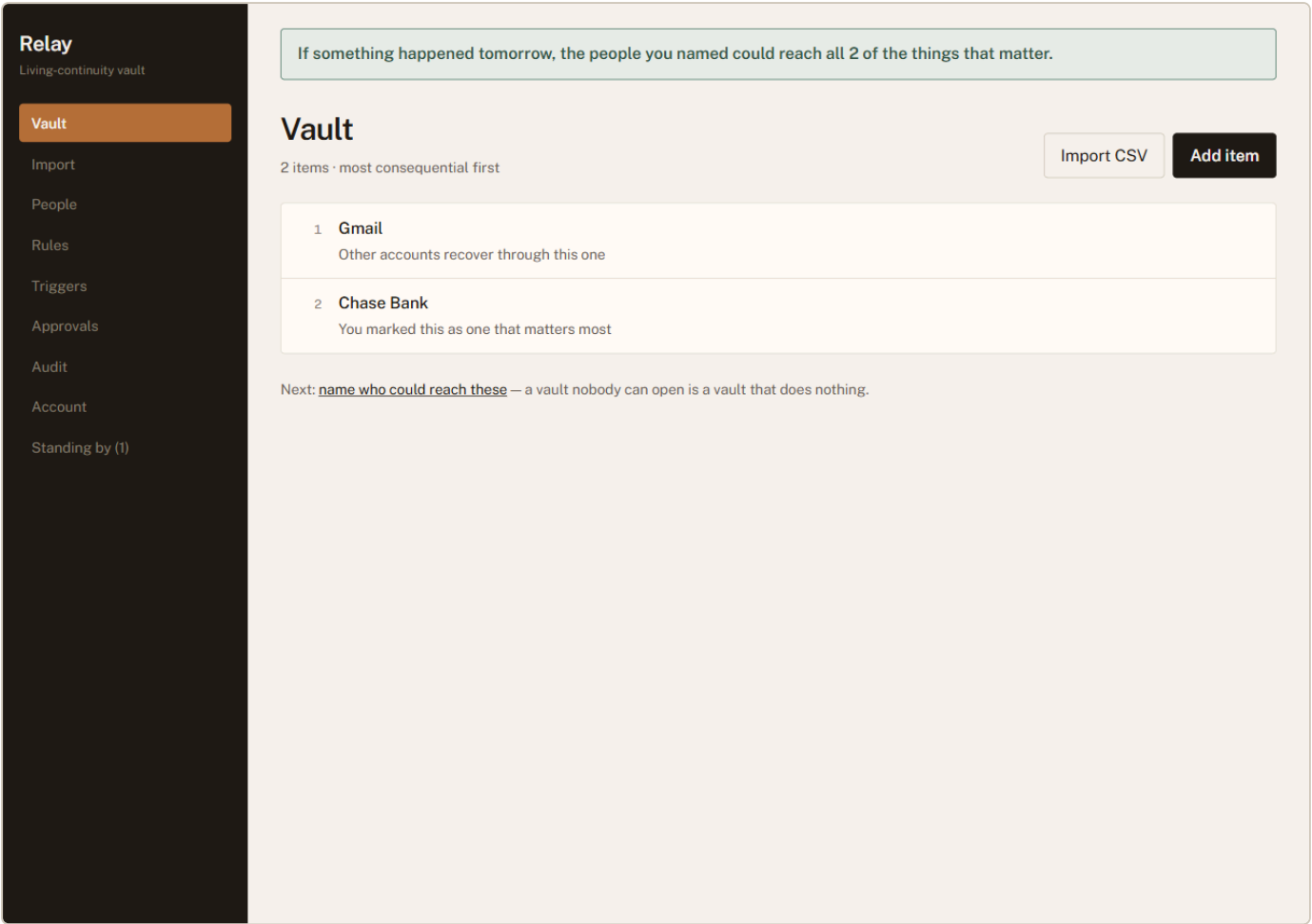
Two access paths are covered throughout. A contact who has *accepted a standby account* signs in as themselves and nothing secret is transmitted when a release opens. A contact who cannot sign in — a recipient who never accepted, or a verified verifier holding no passkey and no authenticator — acts using a single-use code, which is why UC-09, UC-10 and UC-11 show code-entry screens rather than sessions.

Updated 2026-08-12. This paragraph previously said an unaccepted contact keeps the code “guaranteed

permanently by J7-R1". That guarantee was withdrawn the same day: quorum now counts only *verified* people, so a code mailed to an unverified verifier bought a vote with no effect, and the release path stopped minting one. Verifier codes now go only to somebody whose answer counts and who has no other way in.

UC-01 — Know whether the vault could actually open

Actor	Owner
Goal	Find out, without expertise, whether the plan would work in an emergency.
Steps	Sign in → land on the vault.
Expected	A standing statement of how prepared the vault is, on every owner screen, naming what is missing rather than only a colour.
Verified	Pass. Banner states reachability in plain words; items ranked by consequence; root credentials flagged as the reset path for everything else.



UC-01 — the vault, with the standing readiness statement above it.

UC-02 — Build the circle

Actor	Owner
Goal	Name the people who would step in, and make them able to act.
Steps	1. Add a person, choose how their code reaches them (read aloud or emailed). 2. After they accept, call them and compare a four-word phrase. 3. Confirm the match — or reject it, which severs the binding and kills the ticket. 4. For somebody who will never hold an account, record that they are covered by paper only. 5. Issue an emergency code as a way back in.
Expected	Each light says what is <i>missing</i> , not just a state; naming somebody is visibly only half the job; an excluded person stops being nagged about but still counts against the arithmetic.
Verified	Pass. Lights read "Verified — their answer counts", "Accepted — not yet verified, so their answer would not count", "Has not accepted yet — give them their code", "Emergency code only". The fallback line names anybody who could not get back in on a new device.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

Approvals

Audit

Account

Standing by (1)

If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach all 2 of the things that matter.

People

Who would step in, who would be asked whether an emergency is real, and what each of them could reach.

Naming someone is the first half. Once they accept, call them and check the phrase matches — until you do, their answer would not count towards opening anything.

Everyone is named — but 2 of them have not been verified yet.
Until you check it is really them, their answer would not count and nothing would open. It is a two-minute call each.

Suggested starting point

Built from what the importance engine already knows. Accept what fits.

Aunt Margaret gets act access to 1 item on an emergency trigger
Root credentials are the reset path for everything else. Without them, nothing else can be recovered.
Accept

Aunt Margaret gets view access to 1 item on an emergency trigger
Critical money and health accounts are what a caregiver reaches for first.
Accept

Who holds what

PERSON	ROLE	ITEMS REACHABLE
Aunt Margaret	recipient	0 / 2
Jordan Rivera	partner	2 / 2

Who would step in

The people who would receive access. Nothing opens for them until a trigger fires and the people you named confirm it is real — and a person you have not verified cannot receive anything.

- Aunt Margaret recipient Emergency code only

uc-margaret-qa@relaystandby.com

Covered by an emergency code only — Aunt Margaret will not count towards your plan, by your choice. Undo

Emergency code

Remove
- Jordan Rivera partner Verified — their answer counts

uc-spouse-qa@relaystandby.com

Can sign in on a new device.

Verified — undo

Emergency code

Remove

recipient

▼

Add this person

Who confirms it is real

They are asked whether an emergency is real. Their answer only counts once you have checked it is really them. They never see what is inside your vault — only how much, and only when they are asked.

- Dr. Alex Chen Verified — their answer counts

uc-doc-qa@relaystandby.com

No passkey — an emergency code is their only way back in. Worth checking Dr. Alex Chen still knows where it is.

Verified — undo

Emergency code

Remove
- Pat Morgan Has not accepted yet — give them their code

uc-pat-qa@relaystandby.com

Give them a code

Pat Morgan cannot use an account

Emergency code

Remove

Name

Email

Phone (optional)

Add a verifier

UC-02 — every person state on one screen, each with the action that resolves it.

UC-03 — Decide who can reach what

Actor	Owner
Goal	Grant scoped access, tied to a trigger, without granting everything.
Expected	Rules are per item, per person, per trigger. Estate is refused at the API, not merely hidden in a dropdown, until counsel clears it.
Verified	Pass. <code>USER_SELECTABLE_TRIGGER_TYPES</code> is enforced at four separate trust boundaries: <code>/api/rules</code> , <code>/api/policies</code> , <code>/api/triggers/[id]/config</code> , <code>/api/triggers/[id]/initiate</code> .

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If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach all 2 of the things that matter.

Access Rules

Grant a recipient scoped access to an item under a trigger.

Gmail → Jordan Rivera

emergency · view · reversible

Remove

Chase Bank → Jordan Rivera

emergency · view · reversible

Remove

NEW RULE

Vault item

Select an item...

▼

Recipient

Select a recipient...

▼

Trigger type

emergency

▼

Scope

view

▼

☒ Reversible

Release after

0

days

Add rule

UC-03 — access rules.

UC-04 — Configure and run a release

Actor	Owner
Goal	Set how many confirmations a release needs, and be able to stop it.
Expected	A threshold that nobody could satisfy is refused when it is set, rather than discovered as a release that silently never completes. Emergencies are reversible; standing down closes any open dashboard on its next request.
Verified	Pass. The threshold is validated against people who can actually answer — verified contacts only — and a shortfall is reported as a fatal blocker naming the fix. Stand-down was walked end to end: an open access plan closed on reload and the recipient was shown a graceful close rather than an expiry error.

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If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach all 2 of the things that matter.

Triggers

Release state, check-in cadence, and (for demo accounts) the simulate control.

Check-in interval (days)

30

Save

I'm fine — check in

RELEASE STATES

Emergency

ARMED

0/1 confirmations

Initiate

Required confirmations (N):

1

Set

UC-04 — triggers, showing state and confirmations received.

UC-05 — Read what happened while they were away

Actor	Owner
Goal	After an emergency, know what was opened, by whom, and that it is shut.
Expected	A record in plain words — not a hash table.
Verified	Pass. "On 8/12/2026 an emergency was raised, Dr. Alex Chen confirmed it was real, and 1 thing you had set aside was opened. It is closed again now." Items are listed with timestamps; repeat opens of the same item count once. The append-only chain remains below it, with client-side verification.

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Standing by (1)

If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach all 2 of the things that matter.

What happened

5 entries · append-only, hash-chained.

On 8/12/2026 an emergency was raised, Dr. Alex Chen confirmed it was real, and 1 thing you had set aside was opened. It is closed again now.

Gmail — opened 8/12/2026, 1:47:26 PM

Closed 8/12/2026, 1:47:26 PM — because you checked back in. Nothing else was reachable, and nothing stayed open.

Every entry

The full record, in the order it happened. Nothing here can be edited or removed — that is what makes the summary above trustworthy rather than merely reassuring.

SEQ	TIME	ACTOR	ACTION	ENTITY	DETAIL	HASH
0	8/12/2026, 1:47:24 PM	owner:fb7e816f-193c-4706-a8bd-a44bc75b3d4d	break_glass_issued	verifier · 7b79c827	▶ view	92094584176b...
1	8/12/2026, 1:47:25 PM	recipient:fc3ee2d3-eb86-40d1-b099-37fde0270656	trigger_initiated	release_state · a2af0923	▶ view	a50aa3a1219d...
2	8/12/2026, 1:47:25 PM	verifier:7b79c827-9aeb-4350-af8c-4ab933256eae	verifier_confirmed	release_state · a2af0923	—	8df738f965ff...
3	8/12/2026, 1:47:26 PM	recipient:fc3ee2d3-eb86-40d1-b099-37fde0270656	vault_item_decrypted	vault_item · 8009b0db	▶ view	1b92e25dec2a...
4	8/12/2026, 1:47:26 PM	system	release_transition_armed	release_state · a2af0923	▶ view	cbf9bc1f19b9...

UC-05 — the record above, the proof below.

UC-06 — Leave

Actor	Owner
Goal	Take the data out, or close the account entirely.
Expected	Self-serve export and deletion. Closing cancels billing, removes the vault, passkeys, emergency codes and outstanding invitations, and releases the owner from any circle they were standing by for — telling those owners rather than silently shrinking their plan.
Verified	Pass. Deletion was exercised against production repeatedly during this session; every fixture teardown used the product's own deletion path and left zero orphaned rows.

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If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach all 2 of the things that matter.

Your account

Take your data out, or close the account.

Your name

This is how you appear to the people you trust. They see it on every message Relay sends on your behalf — including the one that arrives when something has gone wrong, which is the worst possible moment for it to say an email address they do not recognise.

Margaret Chen

Save name

Passkey

Sign in with your face, fingerprint or device PIN — no code to find, and nothing we could email you that a stranger could imitate. Adding one also means a new phone does not lock you out.

Add a passkey

Recovery codes

Relay has no password. If you lose the phone with your authenticator on it, these codes are the only way back in — so if you cannot find the list you were given at signup, get a new one now, while you still can.

Issuing a new list immediately stops the old one working.

Issue new recovery codes

Subscription and billing

Relay is \$119 a year and renews automatically until you cancel. You can cancel at any time from this page. Nothing in your vault is deleted when a subscription ends — it stays exactly as it is, and the free limits apply only to adding more.

Manage or cancel subscription

Export everything

Downloads a readable file containing every item, decrypted here in your browser, plus the people you have designated. Keep it somewhere you would keep a password list — it is not protected once it leaves.

Export my vault

Close this account

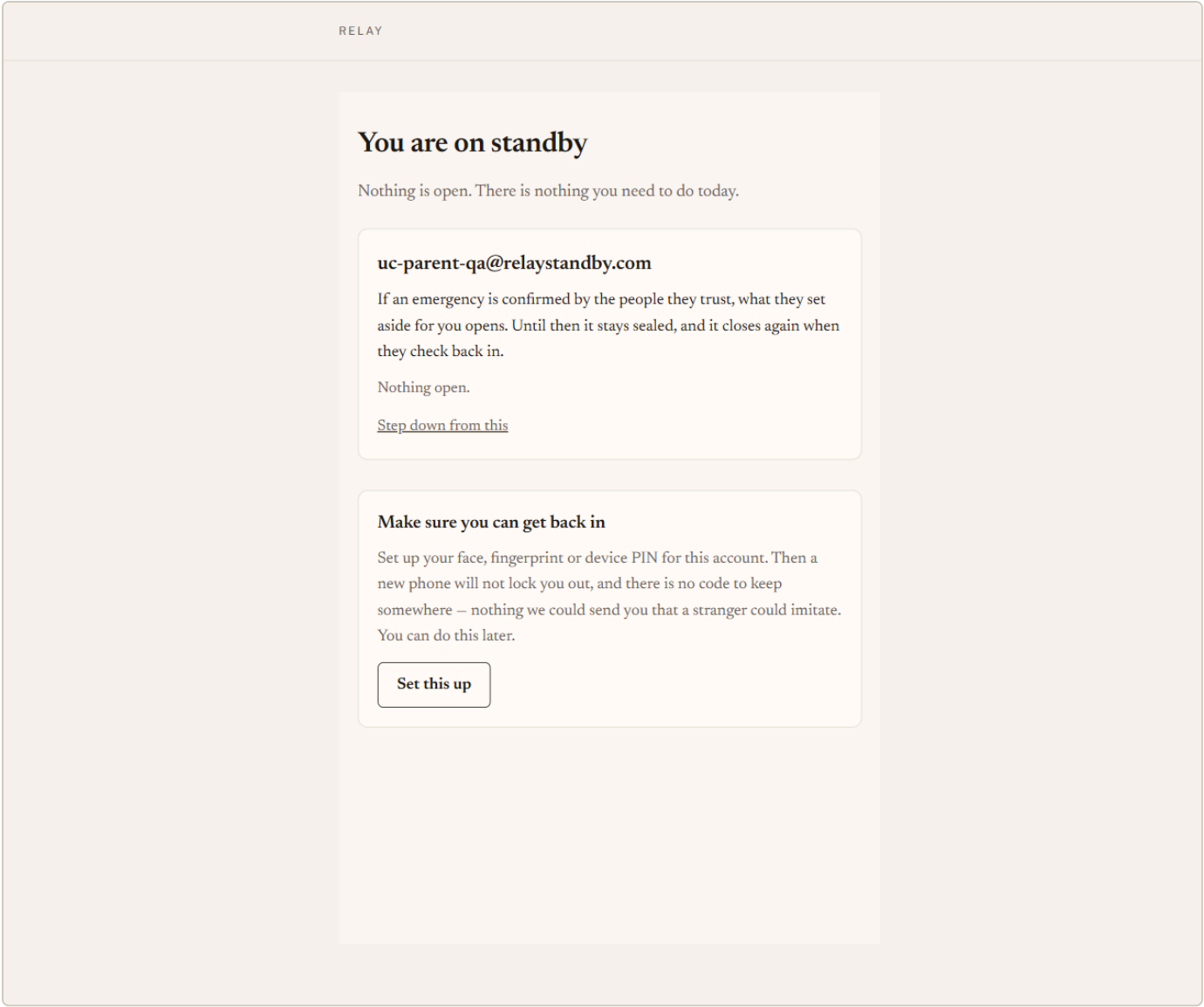
Removes your vault, the people you designated, and your access rules. This cannot be undone, and anyone relying on this vault will lose their access immediately.

The tamper-evident event log is kept, exactly as our privacy page says. It holds no secrets — only the record of what happened and when.

Close my account

UC-07 — Standing by for somebody

Actor	Standby contact
Goal	Know who they are covering and what would be asked of them — without being told.
Expected	The reassuring case is the common one: “Nothing is open. There is nothing you need to do today.” A passkey can be added so a new phone does not lock them out. Stepping down is always available, and the owner is told.
Verified	Pass. Passkey enrolment and usernameless sign-in were proven end to end with a virtual authenticator. Stepping down was proven for both reasons — “I can no longer do this” and “I do not know this person” — which record distinctly in the owner’s audit chain.



UC-07 — the standby dashboard, which is the design centre of the architecture.

UC-08 — Accept a place

Actor	Named contact
Goal	Accept, using a code the owner gave them.
Expected	A typed code, never a link that signs you in. Accepting binds an identity and mints a session in one act.
Verified	Pass. Walked repeatedly on production. The emailed link is bare, so a forwarded invitation grants nothing.

Enter your invitation code

Someone has named you in their Relay plan.
Type the code from the email they sent you.

Code from your email

4KMPQ - 7XR2W

Continue

Nothing is being opened. Accepting only tells them
you have seen it.

UC-09 — Get back in after losing a device

Actor	Standby contact, or somebody who never accepted
Goal	Act when the usual sign-in is gone.
Expected	A single-use emergency code. Using it is loud: it burns itself, emails the owner, and drops the person to unverified so the owner is asked to check again.
Verified	Pass. Redeem → session → standby dashboard. Replay refused. A revoked person is refused, and the refusal does not consume their code.

Use your emergency code

If you were given a code to keep somewhere safe, type it here. It is the way back in when your usual sign-in is not available.

It works once. The person who gave it to you will be told that you used it, and they will be asked to check it was really you – that is deliberate, and it is what makes a code like this safe to carry.

Your emergency code

XXXX - XXXX - XXXX

Continue

No code? Ask the person who named you – they can issue a new one. Relay cannot send you one directly, because a code that arrives in an email is a code anyone who reaches that inbox could use.

UC-10 — Answer “is this real?”

Actor	Verifier
Goal	Attest that an emergency is genuine, without an account and without seeing the vault.
Expected	Three distinct answers — yes, no, I don’t know — with “no” at equal prominence. Scale is shown so proportionality can be judged; contents never are.
Verified	Pass. A verified verifier answers from their dashboard with no token in the URL. An unverified one who has accepted may still answer from their own dashboard; the answer is recorded and audited but does not advance the threshold, and the screen says so rather than thanking them. Since 2026-08-12 they are no longer <i>mailed</i> a code to do it with — the notice tells them plainly that their answer would not count yet.

Enter your code

Someone has asked you to confirm that a situation is genuine. Type the code from the email we sent you.

Code from your email

7 K 4 M - P 2 X W

Continue

You will never be shown anyone's private information — not now, and not after you answer. Relay will never send you a link that signs you in.

UC-11 — Open what was set aside

Actor	Recipient
Goal	Reach what the owner left them, once a release is confirmed.
Expected	A prioritised plan. Decryption happens in the browser; the server returns a wrapped key and never holds plaintext.
Verified	Pass. Authorisation proven by a gate gradient: refused while armed, refused for an out-of-scope item, and reaching AWS KMS for an in-scope item on a released trigger. A re-arm closes the plan on its next request.

Enter your code

Someone arranged for you to reach their accounts, and that access is open. Type the code from the email we sent you.

Code from your email

7 K 4 M - P 2 X W

Continue

[My code has expired](#)

Relay will never send you a link that signs you in.

UC-12 to UC-14 — Public surfaces

Actor	Visitor
Expected	An honest account of what the product does, what it does not, what is stored, and what a standby account is.
Verified	Pass. Terms and Privacy were both rewritten on 2026-08-12 to describe standby accounts, which had been live and taking payments while both documents described a product with one kind of user.

Relay

Sign in

The accounts someone would need, if you could not manage them.

Relay holds them encrypted, opens only what you chose for the person you chose, and only once a real emergency has been confirmed by someone you trust — then closes again when you recover. One price for the whole family, \$119 a year.

I'm caring for a parent

Show me what actually happens

It closes again

Every other way of doing this is a door you open once. Recover, check in, and access ends on its own — which is what makes it safe to set up before you need it.

We cannot read it

Secrets are encrypted in your browser before they reach us. We hold ciphertext, and we are honest on [exactly what we can see](#).

Someone has to say yes

Nothing opens on a timer or a guess. A person you named confirms the situation is real, and never sees anything of yours.

Were you named by someone?

If someone has asked you to be a recipient or a trusted contact, you will have an email with a code in it. Enter it at [relaystandby.com/claim](#). Relay never sends a link that signs you in — if a message claiming to be from us asks you to click one, it is not from us.

Relay — standby access for the people who'll need it.

How it works

Security

Privacy

Terms

Terms

Last updated 12 August 2026

Relay is early-stage software. Please do not make it the only place something important is written down.

What Relay does

Relay stores information you choose to put in it, encrypted in your browser, and releases parts of it to people you designate when conditions you configure are met. You decide what is stored, who can reach it, and under what circumstances.

What Relay does not do

- It is **not a legal instrument**. It is not a will, a power of attorney, or a substitute for either. Estate and inheritance functionality is not offered.
- It does not bypass anyone else's security. It organises access you already have the right to grant.
- It gives you recovery codes when you create your vault, and those are the only way back in if you lose your authenticator. Lose both and we cannot let you in — we can verify a recovery code, but we will not take anyone's word for who they are.
- It offers no uptime guarantee. Keep a copy of anything you cannot afford to lose.

Your responsibilities

Only store information you are entitled to hold. If you set Relay up on behalf of someone else, do it with their knowledge and consent — the software records that consent and reports your activity to them, deliberately.

If someone names you

Someone can name you as a person who would receive access, or as someone who would be asked whether an emergency is real. When they do, they give you a code — read out, texted, or handed to you — and that code sets up a **standby account** in your name.

A standby account is free, and stays free. It holds no vault of its own and it is never billed — not to you, and not to the person who named you. If you also keep a vault of your own, standing by for other people uses none of its allowance. We will never send you a link that signs you in; if a message claiming to be Relay contains one, it is not from us.

Nothing is asked of you until something happens. Until then you can see that you are on standby and who for. If you would receive access, you can see *how much* was set aside for you and roughly what kind of thing it is — never the contents, and never before the conditions they set are met. If you would be asked to confirm an emergency, you are shown nothing about their vault until you are actually asked; at that moment you are told how many things are involved and what kinds, so you can judge whether what is being asked for is proportionate. You are never shown a title, and never the contents — not then, and not afterwards.

You can step down at any time, from your standby page, and you do not need a reason. The person who named you is told, so they can find someone else — that is the point of telling them, and it is why stepping down is not something we will do quietly on your behalf. If you close your account entirely, you are released from every circle you were part of and each of those people is told.

What you do in Relay is recorded in *their* log — when you accepted, when you answered, when you opened something. That is deliberate: it is how they know their plan is real. If you stand by for more than one person, none of them can learn about the others.

Payment and renewal

Relay costs \$119 per year in US dollars for a vault of your own. You are never charged without going through checkout yourself, and there is a free tier you can stay on indefinitely. Standby accounts, described above, are free and are not part of this.

A subscription renews automatically every year at \$119 until you cancel it, and the

card you paid with is charged on each renewal date. Payments are processed by Stripe; we never see or store your card details.

You can cancel at any time from the Subscription section of your account page, which opens Stripe's billing page — the same place you can update your card or read past invoices. Cancelling stops all future charges. Closing your account cancels the subscription too, so you never need to do both.

30-day money-back guarantee. If Relay is not what you expected, email hello@relaystandby.com within 30 days of a charge — including a renewal charge — and we will refund it in full. After that window we do not refund the unused part of a year, though you can cancel at any time to stop the next one. Nothing here removes a refund right the law gives you.

Ending it

You can close your account yourself, at any time, from your account page — it deletes your vault and cancels any subscription in the same step. You can export everything first. We may discontinue the service, and if we do we will give notice and a way to export what you have stored.

Ending a subscription never deletes anything. Your vault stays exactly as it is; the free-tier limits apply only to adding more.

Closing your account also releases you from anyone else's plan you were standing by for, and tells them so. We do not remove you from their list on your behalf — their record of you stays, marked as no longer set up, so their plan gets weaker visibly rather than silently.

Liability

Relay is provided as-is, without warranties. To the fullest extent the law allows, we are not liable for indirect or consequential loss arising from its use.

Contact

hello@relaystandby.com

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Privacy

Last updated 12 August 2026

Relay is early. This page describes exactly what the software does today. Where something is a limitation rather than a protection, it says so.

What we cannot read

The secret content of every vault item — the password, the account number, the note — is encrypted **in your browser** with a key we never receive in usable form. Our servers store only the ciphertext and a copy of that key wrapped by AWS KMS. We cannot decrypt your secrets, and neither can anyone who obtains our database.

What we can read

This is the part most services leave vague, so to be direct: the **labels** you give an item are **not** encrypted. We store, in readable form:

- the item title and service name (e.g. “Chase”)
- the website address you associate with it
- its category and how critical you marked it
- which items you said depend on which others
- your email address, and when you last checked in
- the names, emails and phone numbers of people you designate

So we can tell that you store a Chase account. We cannot tell you anything about it. If the mere existence of an account is sensitive to you, do not label it accurately.

Automated analysis

Relay ranks your items by consequence and works out which credentials others depend on. That analysis runs over the labels above and **never** over your secrets — the component that performs it is technically prevented from decrypting anything. Some of it uses a third-party language model (OpenAI), which therefore receives item labels but never secret content.

Who else is involved

- **Amazon Web Services** — database and key management (United States)
- **Vercel** — hosting and privacy-friendly, cookieless analytics
- **OpenAI** — the labels-only analysis described above
- **Resend** — sending email such as invitations and alerts

We do not sell your data, we do not share it for advertising, and there are no advertising or tracking cookies on this site.

People you designate

When you name a recipient or a trusted contact, we store their name and contact details and may email them. A recipient sees only what you granted them, and only after the conditions you set are met.

A trusted contact is only ever asked whether a situation is real. Until they are asked they see nothing about your vault; at that moment they are told how many items are involved and which categories, so they can judge whether the request is proportionate. They are never shown a title and never any content, at any point.

They can also set up a free **standby account** of their own, described below. If they do, they sign in as themselves rather than following a link you forwarded, and nothing secret is sent to them when your plan opens.

If someone named you

Someone can name you in their plan and give you a code that sets up a standby account. About you, we then hold:

- the name and contact details *they* entered for you — not what you told us
- a sign-in session, kept in a cookie that exists only to keep you signed in
- if you set up a passkey, the public half of it — never anything that could sign as you

- a scrambled form of any emergency code you were given, which we cannot turn back into the code

What you do is recorded in their log, not yours. When you accepted, when you answered a question, when you opened something they left you — all of it lands in the tamper-evident record described above, which belongs to the person who named you. That is how they know their plan works, and you should know it is the arrangement before you take part.

If you stand by for more than one person, **none of them can learn about the others.** There is no screen anywhere that shows one of them your other relationships.

You can step down from any circle at any time from your standby page, and you can close your account outright. Either way the people affected are told, because a plan that quietly gets weaker is the failure this product exists to prevent.

Records we keep

Every access and release event is written to a tamper-evident log so you can audit what happened. That log is append-only by design: entries are never edited or deleted, which means some record of an event survives even after you delete the underlying item.

Deleting your data

You can close your account yourself from your account page, at any time, and export everything first. It removes your vault, the people you listed, your passkeys and any emergency codes you had issued. If you would rather we did it, email us.

Two things deliberately survive. The append-only event log described above stays, and it contains no secret material. And if you were standing by for someone else, their record of you stays on their list — unlinked from you and marked as no longer set up — because deleting it would quietly shrink their plan without telling them.

Contact

hello@relaystandby.com

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